

SOUND DESIGN CHEAT SHEET

MUSIC MOODS

MOOD	BPM	KEY FEEL	BEST FOR
upbeat	118	major, plucks	creators, tutorials
hype	128	minor, pumping	ads, reveals, sport
tech	124	minor, driving	SaaS, AI, product
corporate	110	major, light	brand, LinkedIn, explainer
chill	84	lo-fi, 7th chords	vlogs, calm talking heads
cinematic	72	minor pads, hits	brand films, trailers
playful	120	glockenspiel	kids, food, fun

BEAT MATH

beat = 60 ÷ BPM · bar = 4 beats. Cut on bars, accent on beats. Pick the BPM so the video is a whole number of bars.

SFX: WHEN TO USE

SFX	MOMENT
whoosh / swish	transitions (start 0.3 s before the cut)
pop	text, stickers, chips appear
impact / bass drop	hook, reveal, title slam
riser / downlifter	build into / out of a big moment
click / typing	UI, prompts, buttons
tick	timers, counters
sparkle / ding	magic, success, notification
glitch	errors, digital transitions
shutter	photos, freeze frames

LEVELS

ELEMENT	LEVEL
voice	0 dB reference
music under voice	−8 to −12 dB, ducked a further ~10 dB while speaking

ELEMENT	LEVEL
SFX	-6 to -12 dB (impacts up to -3)
final master	-14 LUFS social · -16 LUFS podcast/web · peaks under -1 dB

■ LICENSING

Generated music/SFX = yours. Client tracks = licensed only. Never put platform-library music in client deliverables.